AN ADVISORY PRODUCT BY STUDIO TONTON GUG

NotchWork.co.uk

Shadow ratings in minutes, not days.

Three full engines — S&P, Moody's, Fitch — each running its published methodology end to end. 35 specialist AI agents. Zero agency fees.

→ Live product: notchwork.co.uk

→ Three full engines live today — 35 specialist agents, 46 Moody's scorecards, 58 Fitch navigators

→ Annual report → full shadow rating in under 10 minutes

→ Target: mid-market CFOs · DCM bankers · rating advisors · PE credit funds

→ **Raising: £500K–£750K Seed at £3.5M pre-money**

Guillaume · Senior IB Professional, London · TGS · October 2026 · Strictly Confidential

Executive summary

The full picture in one page

THE GAP

60,000+ mid-market corporates priced out of agency ratings ($75K–$500K+ per engagement). DCM teams spend weeks on manual scorecards with no methodology backbone or auditability.

THE PRODUCT

Live SaaS platform. Annual report → 35 specialist agents extract and adjust financials per agency → three full ratings (S&P, Moody's, Fitch) with scorecards, narrative, sensitivities, 16:9 PPTX memo. Under 10 min.

THE MOAT

Three full engines + three agency-specific adjustment agents. The grids that determine the rating — Anchor table, CICRA, BRP, industry risk, government-support matrices — are extracted from the published PDFs and pinned by regression tests. Silent 3-way reconciliation when ratings diverge. Auditable, defensible.

THE MARKET

Narrow issuer-pays market $10bn (Big 3 ~91% share); broad credit-risk ecosystem $50–60bn growing 7%+ CAGR. 60K+ unrated mid-market corps. No self-service shadow rating product exists today.

THE MODEL

SaaS £99–£999/mo + Enterprise API £3K–£20K/mo + White-label rev share. Y1: 50 clients → £240K ARR. Y3: 500 SaaS + 10 enterprise → £1.94M revenue. Series A trigger at £1M+ ARR.

THE ASK

£500K–£750K seed at £3.5M pre-money via SAFE/CN. 18-month runway to DBRS + Scope engines, comps DB, first 50 clients, first hire, Series A readiness at £15M+ pre-money.

01

The Problem

90% of the market has no credit voice — and the gap is growing

The credit rating gap

A $50–60bn ecosystem where mid-market is invisible

60K+	$500K	4–8 wks	~91%	$699bn	£200K
Mid-market corps with no external rating	Max S&P initial fee per program	Traditional shadow rating timeline	Big 3 share of US NRSRO revenue	BBB- debt at risk of fallen-angel cliff	Boutique shadow rating advisory fee

Agency fees are prohibitive for 99% of companies

S&P initial rating: $75K–$600K+. Annual surveillance: $50K–$300K per agency. Dual-agency program for a £200M mid-cap: £400K–£1M+ over 5 years.

Banks and advisors are flying blind

DCM teams and advisors spend 2–6 weeks building manual credit scorecards — no standardised methodology, no auditability. Every analyst uses a different Excel.

CFOs have no independent benchmark

Mid-market CFOs preparing a refinancing, USPP issuance, or PE exit have no credible third-party credit estimate. They guess — or pay £50K–£200K for a static, 8-week PDF.

The BBB cliff is a board-level risk

$699bn of BBB- rated debt globally — 28% one notch from HY. Forced selling, RBC tripling at NAIC 2→3 (2.17%→3.15% post-tax, +45%), index exclusion, 100–300 bps spread widening.

02

The Solution

NotchWork — live at notchwork.co.uk · three parallel agency views in under 10 minutes

NotchWork — live product

What users experience today at notchwork.co.uk

> *"Published agency frameworks, not a black box. Every judgment ties back to a specific methodology reference — auditable end to end."*

STEP 01

Upload your docs

Annual report, 10-K, or 20-F. Platform extracts company identity, sector, financials. Optional: peer rating reports, IMs, investor decks — each sharpens the analysis.

STEP 02

Fine-tune with the chatbot

Co-analyst chatbot in plain English. Add peers, correct ratios, discuss financial policy. "My peers are Veolia BBB and Suez BB+." Skip entirely or go deep.

STEP 03

Get the 3-agency view

Three full engines: S&P (CICRA → BRP × FRP → ICR), Moody's (sector scorecard + GRI uplift) and Fitch (Sector Navigator → IDR). Agency-specific adjusted financials, silent 3-way reconciliation, sensitivities, narrative, exportable 16:9 PPTX memo.

```
// Triple-engine rating flow — live (notchwork.co.uk)
S&P:  industry × country → CICRA + competitive → BRP · cash-flow + leverage → FRP · BRP × FRP → anchor + 6 modifiers → SACP + Group/GRE/Sov → ICR
Moody's:  scorecard → other considerations + GRI → CFR    ·    Fitch:  Sector Navigator → SCP + parent/subsidiary linkage → IDR
```

The methodology engine

S&P framework + 46 Moody's scorecards + Fitch sector navigators — rating-determining grids extracted from the published PDFs and regression-tested

S&P CORPORATE FRAMEWORK

Full engine · cached via prompt caching · always hot

- General Corporate Methodology (Apr 2026)
- Ratios & Adjustments — FFO/Debt, Debt/EBITDA
- Industry Risk + Country Risk → CICRA
- Management & Governance · ESG · Liquidity
- Group / GRE / Sovereign caps · Recovery
- Hybrid Capital · Investment Holding Companies
- Auto-retry: anchor matrix + arithmetic check

FULL ENGINES: MOODY'S + FITCH

46 Moody's scorecards + Fitch sector navigators

- Moody's: 46 sector scorecards, thresholds and weights extracted from the PDFs · GRI JDA grid
- Fitch: sector navigators (Master + Addendum) with 10 standard navigator factors · PSL linkage
- Three adjustment agents — each agency's full accounting treatment (leases, hybrids, pensions, factoring…) applied to the same reported figures

INFRASTRUCTURE

AI-native · cost-efficient · audit-friendly

- 35 specialist AI agents (Claude, Anthropic)
- Prompt caching: 10× input cost reduction
- Supabase pgvector RAG (1,144 S&P chunks)
- 3-way reconciliation (silent, >2 notch trigger)
- Auto-retry on arithmetic + factor whitelist
- Methodology / sector sanity-check on each agency
- Cost: ~£0.65 marginal per 3-agency rating

3-way reconciliation runs silently: if any pair of S&P / Moody's / Fitch disagrees by >2 notches, all three engines re-run with the others' views as context. The user just sees the final ratings.

03

Market Opportunity

$10bn narrow market · $50–60bn ecosystem · 60K+ underserved corps · zero direct competitors

Market size — TAM / SAM / SOM

Three overlapping addressable markets; conservative SOM

TAM

$50–60bn

Global credit-risk ecosystem

Ratings ($10bn) + analytics + platforms + data + research

SAM

$8.5bn

Self-service + advisory shadow ratings

Mid-market corps + PE + bank DCM + boutique credit advisory

SOM Y3

£4M+

NotchWork 3-year revenue target

0.05% of SAM · 500 SaaS × £160 ARPU + 10 enterprise × £72K

Why now — five forces opening the window in 2026

1. AI crossed the threshold (Claude 200K context + prompt caching → £0.50/dual rating, impossible 18 months ago)
2. BBB cliff anxiety at 15-year high — $699bn BBB- debt, 28% one notch from HY
3. S&P + Moody's fees hit record highs in 2024–25; mid-market affordability gap widening
4. Private credit AUM $2T+; 300K+ unrated borrowers need shadow ratings for NAIC, LP reporting, monitoring
5. NRSRO/CRP regulatory plumbing tightening (NAIC SVO deactivation Jan 2026, ECAI CRR III) → demand for auditable independent views

04

Business Model

SaaS + Enterprise + White-label — three compounding revenue streams

Three revenue streams, compounding

Recurring SaaS core · enterprise upside · white-label leverage

STREAM 1 · SaaS Subscription

Analyst — **£99/mo**

1 user · 5 ratings/mo · PDF export · independent advisors

Professional — **£299/mo**

3 users · unlimited ratings · PPTX · API · comps

Team — **£999/mo**

10 users · priority support · chatbot enrichment · white-label output

STREAM 2 · Enterprise API

Bank / DCM Team — **£3K–£15K/mo**

Unlimited ratings · white-label · S&P + Moody's · custom benchmarks · SLA

PE / Credit Fund — **£5K–£20K/mo**

Portfolio monitoring · bulk upload · NAIC guidance · real-time alerts

Advisory boutique — **Rev share 30%**

White-label NotchWork as own IP · client billing stays with boutique

STREAM 3 · Data & Intelligence

Comps Database — **Y2+, included**

Anonymised benchmarks from aggregated platform ratings · sector P25/P50/P75

API Data Feeds — **£500/mo**

Bulk shadow rating exports for systematic FI strategies and PE portfolio tools

Research Reports — **£2K–£10K**

Sector credit-trend reports for institutional audiences (Utilities, Healthcare, Infra)

Unit economics — best-in-class SaaS

Conservative base case · margin profile that breaks even on first enterprise

SaaS ARPU (blended)

£160/mo

£1,920/yr

Enterprise ARPU

£6K/mo

£72K/yr

Monthly churn target

< 5%

Industry avg 3–8%

CAC (IB channel)

£200–£400

vs £2K+ inbound avg

LTV (24mo, SaaS)

£3,840

LTV/CAC > 10×

Payback period

< 3 months

Best-in-class SaaS

Marginal cost / dual rating

£0.50

Anthropic + Vercel + Supabase

Gross margin

80–84%

After scale

Key insight

1 enterprise contract (£72K ARR) ≈ 100 SaaS subscribers. The enterprise channel is the asymmetric upside — and the founder's IB network is the direct activation path. Marginal cost £0.50 / rating means even £99/mo Analyst tier carries 96%+ contribution margin.

05

Competition & Moat

White space confirmed · technical moat built · clock ticking on the arbitrage window

Competitive landscape

NotchWork occupies uncontested white space — five reasons no one else can replicate quickly

	Big 3 (S&P/Moody's/Fitch)	Boutique advisors	Generic AI tools	NotchWork
Methodology backbone	Yes (proprietary)	Mostly Excel	No	**Yes — extracted + tested**
Cross-agency reconciliation	No	Manual	No	**Yes — auto, >2 notch trigger**
Self-service	No (multi-week)	No (4-8wk delivery)	Yes (no methodology)	**Yes (under 10 min)**
Auditable output	Yes	PDF only	Hallucinations risk	**Yes — PPTX + cite refs**
Cost per rating	$75K–$500K+	£50K–£200K	$0–$20	**£0.65 marginal (3 agencies)**
Speed	6–12 weeks	4–8 weeks	Minutes	**Under 10 minutes**

Technical moat: 18 S&P PDFs + 46 Moody's scorecards + Fitch sector navigators extracted from source + three agency-specific adjustment agents + cross-agency reconciliation, with the rating-determining grids pinned by regression tests. 12–18 months for a competitor to rebuild from zero — and the methodology PDFs keep updating.

06

Go-To-Market

IB network first · content second · enterprise third — sequenced for capital efficiency

Go-to-market — three phases

Sequenced by capital efficiency · IB network is the cheat code for first 25 clients

PHASE 1 · Now → M6

IB network — first 25 clients

- Direct outreach via IB network + EDHEC alumni
- Target: DCM analysts · CFOs preparing bond issuance · rating advisory teams
- Offer: free Professional plan (30 days) → convert to £299/mo paid
- Positioning: 'I build these models in my day job — try it on your next client'
- Day-1 pipeline: 40+ warm contacts already identified

PHASE 2 · M6–12

Content + community

- LinkedIn thought leadership: 'shadow rating of the week' series
- Targeted Google/LinkedIn ads: 'shadow rating', 'S&P methodology', 'credit assessment'
- Partner with 2–3 rating advisory boutiques (referral + white-label deals)
- /rating-introduction hub drives organic SEO — 9 tabs, 2026-grade content
- Target: 50 paying clients, £240K ARR run-rate

PHASE 3 · M12–18

Enterprise & white-label

- Package NotchWork as white-label for advisory boutiques (rev share 30%)
- First enterprise bank API contract — 1 deal = £72K ARR (= 100 SaaS subscribers)
- PE / credit fund channel: portfolio monitoring for 100+ unrated borrowers
- USPP / NAIC module: designation guidance, NPA covenant context
- Target: 200 clients, £1.2M ARR, Series A materials prepared

07

Founder & Team

10 years of the problem · already shipped · network is the moat

The founder

Domain insider × builder × IB network

Guillaume · Founder & CEO

Role	Corporate Advisory & Transaction Execution — major IB, London
Focus	Event-driven finance · debt advisory · rating advisory — Healthcare & Utilities
Domain	10+ years advising issuers on debt structuring, ratings strategy, capital-markets access
Methodology	Builds S&P/Moody's shadow-rating models in the day job. Knows the gaps from the inside.
Education	EDHEC Business School (Finance)
Builder	3 live products: NotchWork · NewsBeats · Amazon KDP. Stack: Next.js, Claude API, Supabase, Vercel.
Network	IB + EDHEC alumni + DCM = direct activation path for first enterprise clients

5 unfair advantages

Domain insider

Does this exact work at a bulge-bracket IB. Knows the methodology gaps, client pain, and bank DCM workflow from the inside.

IB distribution ready

Warm access to 40+ DCM teams, advisors, CFOs. First 25 clients require zero paid CAC — LinkedIn messages.

Builder already shipped

3 live products. NotchWork is not a prototype — live today at notchwork.co.uk. Modern stack: Next.js, Vercel, Claude.

Technical moat built

Three full engines · 46 Moody's scorecards · 58 Fitch navigators · 12–18 months for a competitor to rebuild.

First mover — window open

Zero self-service shadow-rating products exist globally. Big 3 won't cannibalize themselves.

08

The Ask

£500K–£750K Seed · £3.5M pre-money · 18 months to Series A

The ask — Seed round

Terms · use of funds · 18-month milestones

Round terms

Raise

£500K – £750K

Instrument

SAFE / Convertible Note

Pre-money valuation

£3.5M

Post-money (£750K)

£4.25M

Equity offered

~15–18%

Use period

18 months

Series A trigger

£1M+ ARR run-rate

Use of funds

Product (DBRS engine, comps DB, NAIC/USPP module, mobile)	40%
Go-to-market (first 50 clients, outreach, content)	30%
Team (first hire — month 6, product/growth)	20%
Legal, IP protection, compliance	10%



18-month milestones

M1–2	**Seed close + scale prep** *Audit log · multi-user teams · session sharing*
M3	**DBRS engine + comps DB** *4-agency cross-check · anonymised peer benchmarks*
M4–5	**First 10 paying clients** *IB outreach · onboarding feedback loop*
M6	**First hire** *Product/growth · white-label pipeline opened*
M8	**50 clients · £240K ARR** *Enterprise API v1 · first bank conversations*
M10	**First enterprise contract** *1 bank deal = £72K ARR · validates thesis*
M12	**USPP / NAIC module** *Designation guidance · portfolio monitoring v1*
M15	**200 clients · £1.2M ARR** *Series A materials prepared*
M18	**Series A raise** *£3–5M target at £15M+ pre-money*

Why now — 5 forces creating the window

A once-in-a-decade confluence of market, technology, and regulation

1

AI crossed the threshold (2024)

Claude's 200K context + prompt caching ingests S&P + 46 Moody's scorecards + 58 Fitch navigators at £0.65 marginal per 3-agency rating. 18 months ago this unit economics was impossible.

2

BBB cliff anxiety at 15-year high

$699bn BBB- debt globally; 28% one notch from HY; $387bn on negative outlook. CFOs, boards, lenders never more focused on real-time credit positioning.

3

Agency fees hit record highs in 2024–25

S&P + Moody's both raised rack rates 10–15%. Mid-market affordability gap widening. New class of frustrated mid-market issuers being pushed out of agency programs.

4

Private credit AUM > $2T = 300K+ unrated borrowers

Private credit boom. Virtually all PC borrowers unrated. PE sponsors, direct lenders, CLO managers need shadow ratings for NAIC, LP reporting, monitoring.

5

Regulatory plumbing tightening — but with no Big-3 alternative

NAIC SVO deactivation effective Jan 1 2026 (3-notch override authority). CRR III + ECAI rotation. Yet zero self-service alternative exists. Big 3 won't cannibalize themselves.

Product roadmap — 18 months

Seed → DBRS + comps DB → 50 clients → Enterprise → Series A

NOW

Seed close

- ✓ S&P engine live (full methodology)
- ✓ Moody's engine live (46 scorecards)
- ✓ Fitch engine live (58 navigators)
- ✓ 3 agency adjustment agents
- ✓ Doc upload pipeline + chatbot
- ✓ 16:9 IB memo export (PPTX)
- ✓ 3-min product film on the site
- ✓ Rating hub + Beyond-Big-3 deck

Q4 2026

DBRS + comps DB

- → DBRS Morningstar integration
- → Comps DB seeding (anonymised)
- → FMP / EDGAR data layer
- → Enterprise API v1
- → First 25 clients
- → White-label v1 prototype

Q1 2027

Platform scale

- → Comps DB public release
- → NAIC / USPP designation module
- → Multi-user teams · audit log
- → 50 clients · £240K ARR
- → First enterprise deal
- → Sector benchmark reports

Q2–Q3 2027

Series A prep

- → Scope Ratings integration
- → KBRA / AM Best modules
- → Mobile app (issuer monitoring)
- → Sector credit-trend research
- → 200 clients · £1.2M ARR
- → Series A close

Seed close → DBRS + comps DB (M3) → 50 clients/£240K ARR (M8) → Enterprise contract (M10) → Series A ready (M18)

Technology stack

Modern, scalable, cost-efficient — built on AI-native infrastructure

Frontend

- Next.js 16 (App Router) + TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS v4 + shadcn/ui components
- Streaming Server-Sent Events (SSE) for real-time output
- Auth + sessions via Supabase

AI Engine

- 35 specialist Claude agents (Anthropic) via API
- Prompt caching: 18 S&P PDFs + 46 Moody's scorecards + 58 Fitch navigators
- RAG: Supabase pgvector (1,536-dim embeddings, 1,144 chunks)
- 3-way silent reconciliation + retry loops + factor/navigator whitelist

Backend & Data

- Supabase (Postgres + pgvector + auth + storage)
- 5 core tables: methodology_chunks · rating_sessions · session_documents · comps_database · chat_messages
- Keep-alive cron (GitHub Actions, M+Th)
- FMP API for public comps; EODHD on roadmap

Infrastructure

- Vercel (frontend + API) + dedicated Render worker (no timeout on long ratings)
- GitHub Actions (CI/CD + cron)
- Cloudflare R2 storage option
- PptxGenJS + react-pdf for export pipelines

Cost at scale: ~£0.65 marginal per 3-agency rating · ~£20/mo Vercel Pro + £25/mo Supabase Pro at volume · Total infra at 50 users: ~£60/mo

NotchWork.co.uk

Independent credit insight. Three parallel agency views. Zero Big 3 fees.

Raising £500K–£750K Seed · £3.5M pre-money · 18 months to Series A

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Guillaume · Senior IB Professional, London · TGS

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